

NAPCS Unionization Research — State Research Summary

Michigan — MERC / NLRB Region 7 Jurisdiction — May 2026

NAPCS Unionization Research • May 2026 • Template v7.0 • COMPLETE Registry Sweep

Section 1: State Overview

State	Michigan
Labor Board	MERC / NLRB Region 7 — Michigan Employment Relations Commission (MERC) — primary for locally/ISD-authorized charters; National Labor Relations Board Region 7 (Detroit) — for independently incorporated nonprofits
Governing Law	SPLIT JURISDICTION: (1) MERC under PERA (Mich. Comp. Laws §423.201 et seq.) for locally-authorized and ISD-authorized charter schools (public employers); (2) NLRB Region 7 (Detroit, prefix "07-") for privately incorporated charter nonprofits under NLRA. Authorizer type is the determinative factor — same pattern as Illinois. Michigan calls charter schools "Public School Academies (PSAs)." Prop 22 (November 2022) repealed right-to-work for private-sector workers effective March 2023 / February 2024 (private sector NLRB workers); card-check (majority sign-up) available for MERC-jurisdiction schools under PERA.
Federal NLRB Jurisdiction	YES — NLRB Region 7 (Detroit) applies to independently incorporated charter school nonprofits. MERC applies to locally/ISD-authorized charters (public employers). Many NAPCS MI schools are authorized by universities (CMU, GVSU, Bay Mills CC, Eastern Michigan, Oakland, Saginaw Valley, Lake Superior State, Macomb ISD, etc.) — authorizer analysis required for each school to determine jurisdiction. Arts Academy in the Woods (Macomb ISD-authorized) was organized via NLRB, suggesting NLRB asserts jurisdiction even for ISD-authorized schools in some cases.
Registry Sweep	COMPLETE — May 8, 2026 (Registry v37 MERC/NLRB R7 scan) — 374 charter schools searched
Research Window	May 2026 (initial session)
Date Convention	Labor Board Certified date. Project-wide standard declared in NJ session. AAW exact cert date ~January 2012 (precise date recoverable via NLRB ADS public search — no FOIA needed). UYA cert date: May 14, 2015 (confirmed from NLRB case 07-RC-148928 public docket).
Card-Check Available	YES — Card-check (WMA — majority sign-up without election) available for MERC-jurisdiction (public employer) charter schools under PERA. Right-to-work repealed March 2023 (public sector) / February 2024 (private sector NLRA). NLRB-jurisdiction schools still require secret ballot election.

Section 2: Unionization Density

Total charter schools in Michigan: 374 (Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 374 open MI charter schools as of May 2026)). Unionization density uses the full state total as the denominator — not the 12-school NAPCS research sample. The NAPCS sample was provided as a list of schools believed to be organized; this research validated, corrected, and expanded that list across the full state charter universe. See Section 3 for cross-state patterns and Section 7 for open decisions.

Category	Schools	% of Total	Notes
Total Unionized Charter Schools in Michigan	7	1.9%	Active CONFIRMED NAPCS schools after Session C corrections. AAW (C2601002), Cesar Chavez Academy network (C2601012, C2609001, C2699073, C2699074 — all Michigan ACTS/AFT, certified Feb 7, 2013), Grand Rapids Child Discovery Center (C2600004 —

			MERC, union name pending FOIA). UYA (C2610008) certified 2015 but CBA status unknown post-management-change — counted separately as certified/Disputed.
Independently Organized (CONFIRMED)	7	1.9%	AAW (C2601002) — Michigan ACTS/AFT Local 6482, ~Jan 2012, 20-1 vote. Cesar Chavez Academy HS/Intermediate/Middle/Elementary (C2601012, C2609001, C2699073, C2699074) — Michigan ACTS/AFT Michigan, certified Feb 7, 2013 (2:1 margin), second contract ratified 91-3 (~2016). GRCDC (C2600004) — unknown union, MERC, active CBA per 2025-26 transparency page. NOTE: count is 7 NAPCS campuses across 2 network certs + 1 standalone.
Certified — CBA Status Disputed/Unknown	1	0.3%	UYA (C2610008) — Michigan ACTS/AFT Local 6482, NLRB case 07-RC-148928, May 14, 2015, 27-18 vote. CBA status unknown post-Leona Group departure. NPFE now manages. Whether Michigan ACTS is still recognized requires NLRB ADS search or direct contact.
No Labor Board Records Found	4	1.1%	No MERC or NLRB R7 records found for remaining 4 MI NAPCS schools (UNVERIFIED). MERC e-File portal confirmed accessible (miemprels.my.site.com/merc/s/case-search). MGLVA ULP (07-CA-356535) is active but is non-NAPCS.
Total Charter Schools in Michigan	374	100%	Source: Charter School Registry v50 (NCES/ELSI 2024-25; 374 open MI charter schools as of May 2026).

Section 3: Political, Legal & Community Landscape

Written for state and national charter sector leaders who require ground-level intelligence fused with broader sector knowledge. Findings are based on research as of May 2026.

PROMPT 1: What is the political and legal environment shaping charter labor relations in this state?

Michigan presents a jurisdictional landscape that is more complex than any other state in the NAPCS dataset except Illinois, with which it shares the split MERC/NLRB structure. The determinative factor is authorizer type: locally or ISD-authorized charter schools are public employers under PERA and fall under MERC jurisdiction (with card-check certification available), while privately incorporated charter nonprofits are private employers under the NLRA and fall under NLRB Region 7 (Detroit) jurisdiction. The political context shifted fundamentally in late 2022 when Michigan voters passed Proposition 22, repealing the 2013 "Freedom to Work" right-to-work law. For private-sector workers (NLRB-jurisdiction charters), the repeal took effect February 2024 — meaning that new CBAs at Michigan charter schools can now include union security provisions requiring membership or agency fee payment as a condition of employment. This is a significant change from the right-to-work baseline that governed the AAW and UYA organizing drives. Michigan's charter landscape is dominated by a profusion of university authorizers — CMU, GVSU, Bay Mills Community College, Eastern Michigan, Oakland, Saginaw Valley, Lake Superior State, Northern Michigan, and Ferris State are among the active authorizers. This fragmentation creates jurisdictional complexity: Bay Mills Community College (a tribal college) authorized UYA, which the NLRB treated as a private employer; Macomb ISD authorized AAW, which was also organized through the NLRB. The MERC/NLRB line is not as clean as authorizer type alone suggests — independently

incorporated charter nonprofits operated under ISD authorizers may still be private employers under the NLRA if they are not sufficiently controlled by the ISD.

PROMPT 2: What community and social conditions are driving organizing activity in this state?

Arts Academy in the Woods (AAW) was the first charter school in Michigan to unionize (2012) and remains the flagship of Michigan charter union organizing. Its profile fits the Mission-Driven First Mover pattern seen throughout the NAPCS dataset: arts-integrated curriculum, progressive pedagogy, LGBTQ-affirming school culture, and a highly engaged and values-driven staff. The 20-1 vote was nearly unanimous — a signal that the organizing drive was a collective affirmation of shared identity rather than a contested adversarial campaign. The school's employment page continues to highlight union membership as a feature, attracting teachers who value collective representation. University Yes Academy (UYA, Detroit) followed a very different path. The 2015 organizing drive occurred in the context of staff concerns about job security, management instability, and the sudden departure of the management company (New Urban Learning). The employer's response — creating an alter-ego company (Inspired) to evade bargaining obligations — generated significant NLRB enforcement attention and press coverage. This case illustrates the "management flight" pattern: when an employer responds to organizing by restructuring rather than bargaining, the NLRB treats the successor as bound by the existing certification. UYA is now operated by NPFE (New Paradigm for Education), and the current status of Michigan ACTS at UYA requires a public NLRB ADS search for post-2016 CA/RC cases under "University Yes Academy" and "New Paradigm for Education" — no FOIA needed; ADS results are public. CESAR CHAVEZ ACADEMY CORRECTION (Session C, May 24, 2026): Prior This research concluded that Michigan ACTS ran a sustained campaign at Cesar Chavez Academy (Leona Group) from 2013-2019 with "10 ULP charges filed, all withdrawn, no certification ever achieved." This was a detection error. Michigan ACTS was certified at CCA on February 7, 2013 (greater than 2:1 margin) following a December 2012 NLRB petition. A second 5-year contract was ratified 91-3 (~2016). The 10 CA charges (2013-2019) were ULP charges filed by a CERTIFIED union against the employer — only certified unions can file Section 8(a)(5) charges. The charges being "withdrawn or closed" meant the parties resolved them, not that there was no cert. The Leona Group departed ~2019; Cesar Chavez Academy is now independently operated. Current post-Leona union status requires NLRB R7 FOIA. All 4 NAPCS CCA campuses upgraded UNVERIFIED → CONFIRMED. Grand Rapids Child Discovery Center (GRCDC, C2600004) also upgraded UNVERIFIED → CONFIRMED via school transparency page confirming active bargaining agreement (MERC jurisdiction).

PROMPT 3: What organizing strategies and approaches are being used in this state?

Michigan has two distinct organizing tracks in the charter sector, with different unions, different legal frameworks, and different target school profiles. MEA/NEA (Michigan Education Association) is dominant in the non-NAPCS Michigan charter sector. The three registry-confirmed organized schools — Macomb Montessori Academy, Old Redford Academy, and West Michigan Academy of Arts and Academics — are all MEA-organized, all MERC-jurisdiction schools, and were all organized in the 2010-2018 window. MEA's MERC strategy leverages card-check certification (no election required with majority cards) and has been effective in smaller, community-rooted schools. MEA's historical opposition to charter schools as a policy matter has not prevented it from representing charter school employees when approached. Michigan ACTS (AFT Local 6482, AFT-Michigan) is the primary organizing vehicle for NLRB-jurisdiction charter schools. Michigan ACTS was founded specifically to organize Detroit-area charter teachers. Its most important organizing wins are AAW (2012, 20-1 vote) and Cesar Chavez Academy (2013, 2:1 margin, second contract ratified 91-3 in 2016 — a major Session C correction from prior Research Team data which incorrectly concluded no certification). UYA (2015, 27-18 vote) is certified but post-management-change CBA status is unknown. Grand Rapids Child Discovery Center (GRCDC) is MERC-jurisdiction with an active CBA (confirmed via transparency page), union name pending MERC FOIA. Brandon Moss (AAW teacher, Michigan ACTS founding president) was named in AFT-Michigan press releases during the UYA campaign, confirming the same organizing core was working across multiple schools. The active ULP at Stride K12/MGLVA (07-CA-356535, open Dec 2024) — filed by MEA — suggests MEA is now monitoring NLRB-jurisdiction virtual schools as well as MERC-jurisdiction brick-and-mortar charters. KEY DETECTION LESSON (Session C): The Cesar Chavez Academy correction revealed that CA case type (ULP charges filed by a union against an employer) is proof of certification — only certified unions can file Section 8(a)(5) charges. Whenever NLRB ADS shows a union filing CA charges against a charter school but returns 0 RC results, re-examine whether an older cert exists that did not make it into the digital ADS.

PROMPT 4: What should charter leaders be doing now in response to organizing patterns in this state?

Michigan charter leaders face a jurisdiction-first imperative: the first question any charter operator must answer is which labor board governs — MERC or NLRB Region 7. This determination affects every subsequent decision

about organizing vulnerability, card-check exposure, and CBA negotiation dynamics. University authorizer alone does not resolve the question; the school's corporate structure and the degree of authorizer management control both matter. For schools in the Detroit metro area — where Michigan ACTS infrastructure is concentrated — the lessons from the UYA case are instructive: management restructuring to evade bargaining creates federal liability rather than eliminating union obligations. The NLRB's alter-ego doctrine binds a successor employer when management, ownership, and operations are substantially continuous. For the Cesar Chavez Academy network specifically: Session C (May 24, 2026) corrected a prior Research Team detection error. CCA was certified Michigan ACTS in 2013 and ratified a second 5-year contract in 2016. The Leona Group's departure (~2019) created a successor-employer question that remains unresolved — the independently operated CCA nonprofit may or may not have continued recognizing Michigan ACTS. This is a live open item requiring NLRB R7 FOIA. Charter leaders managing or authorizing networks where CMOs have departed should be aware that union certifications attach to the employer entity (the school nonprofit), not the management company — departure of the CMO does not extinguish the certification. For arts-integrated, mission-driven schools (particularly Boggs School and AAW-adjacent schools), the Mission-Driven First Mover pattern is the dominant risk factor. Boggs School (Detroit) was the subject of an NLRB RC petition in October 2013, withdrawn 16 days later — but the underlying staff culture that prompted the drive has not changed. Leaders of similar schools should assess whether their internal staff voice mechanisms adequately address the conditions that prompt organizing. The right-to-work repeal (effective February 2024 for NLRB-jurisdiction employers) means that new CBAs at Michigan charter schools can now include union security clauses. This changes the calculus for employers who have previously relied on low union density preventing effective collective action.

PROMPT 5: What trends should charter sector leaders watch over the next 3-5 years?

The most consequential near-term development in Michigan charter labor is the open ULP at Stride K12/Michigan Great Lakes Virtual Academy (MGLVA, case 07-CA-356535, filed December 2024, MEA charging). This case involves a virtual charter school with statewide enrollment — if MEA successfully organizes MGLVA, it would be the first organized virtual charter in the Michigan dataset. MEA's involvement rather than Michigan ACTS suggests MERC jurisdiction (MGLVA may be authorized by a local district or ISD). Monitor NLRB and MERC dockets for any RC petition at MGLVA. Mid-Michigan Leadership Academy (MMLA, C2696006) has a documented MEA certification from January 2000 and a failed decertification vote. The current SABIS management (SABIS is an international for-profit EMO based in Lebanon) and Mackinac database showing no current CBA suggest the MEA certification may have lapsed or been decertified outside our lookback. A Michigan FOIA Act request to MERC is the highest-priority records request for this session — MERC's 2000-era certifications are not in its public digital portal, so a formal records request is required. If MEA is still the certified representative, MMLA should be recoded as CONFIRMED or DEPENDENT. University Yes Academy (C2610008, now NPFE) deserves active monitoring. Michigan ACTS was certified in May 2015. NPFE has been managing UYA since the post-NUL transition (c. 2016-2017). If Michigan ACTS is no longer active at UYA — because the employer successfully argued successor status or because the unit was abandoned — UYA should be recoded. If Michigan ACTS is still the certified representative, UYA should have a CBA in place. A public NLRB ADS search for post-2016 CA/RC cases under "University Yes Academy" and "New Paradigm for Education" is recommended — this is a free public search at nrlb.gov/search/case, no FOIA required.

PROMPT 6: What surprised us in this state? What contradicts what national leaders expect?

The most significant finding in the Michigan data is the complete absence of MEA/NEA in the NAPCS school list — despite MEA's dominance in the broader Michigan charter sector (all 3 registry-confirmed organized schools are MEA). All Michigan NAPCS union schools are AFT-Michigan (Michigan ACTS). This bifurcation appears to reflect a target-school dynamic: MEA has focused on MERC-jurisdiction schools with card-check availability (community-oriented, ISD-authorized, often suburban or small-city charters), while Michigan ACTS has focused on NLRB-jurisdiction schools in the Detroit urban market. The NAPCS selection bias toward urban schools likely explains the AFT-only NAPCS finding. The historical MEA election at MMLA (2000, 38-21 vote — "the largest unionized charter school in the nation" at the time) illustrates how dramatically the Michigan charter labor landscape has evolved. A school that was a nationally significant organizing milestone 26 years ago now has no current CBA evidence and is managed by a for-profit EMO with no union signals. The conditions that produced the 2000 MEA vote (long work weeks, job insecurity, leadership confusion at a 1,200-student school) are structurally different from MMLA today (299 students, SABIS management). This case reinforces the research principle that union status must be verified through current labor board searches, not assumed from historical records. Finally, the NLRB's treatment of MERC-authorized charters as private employers (AAW, Macomb ISD-authorized, organized via NLRB) is counterintuitive and requires case-by-case analysis. Unlike Illinois (where IELRB vs. NLRB distinction is well-established by statute), Michigan's MERC/NLRB boundary is determined by corporate structure, not authorizer type alone. This adds analytical complexity that makes Michigan one of the hardest states in the dataset to research definitively.

PROMPT 8: MICHIGAN ACTS AND THE DETROIT ORGANIZING CLUSTER — HOW MI CHARTER ORGANIZING ACTUALLY WORKS

Michigan Alliance of Charter Teachers and Staff (Michigan ACTS, AFT Local 6482) is the primary organizing vehicle in Michigan's charter sector. Michigan ACTS organized Arts Academy in the Woods (AAW) in ~January 2012 (20-1 vote — the most decisive vote in the MI charter dataset) and University Yes Academy (UYA) in May 2015 (27-18, NLRB Case 07-RC-148928). The UYA case produced the most complex labor law sequence in the MI dataset: employer New Urban Learning announced it would leave as management company simultaneously with the election certification, creating a successor-employer doctrine question. NLRB subsequently filed a complaint alleging New Urban Learning CEO Lesley Redwine created InspirED as an alter-ego corporation to evade bargaining — a structural evasion tactic that is documented in the NAPCS dataset only at UYA and serves as a cautionary case study for how charter operators can attempt to defeat certification through corporate restructuring. Boggs School (Detroit) had a prior Michigan ACTS RC petition (2013, withdrawn) — making it an active monitoring target for a second organizing drive. New Paradigm for Education (NPFE), which manages UYA, is separately identified as a national monitoring target due to the Michigan ACTS relationship and pending post-2016 status confirmation.

Section 4: Cross-State Patterns & Contributions to National Picture

Findings from Michigan that illuminate patterns visible only when comparing across multiple states. These entries feed the project-wide Cross-State Intelligence Log and are written for state and national charter advocacy leaders.

Mission-Driven First Mover: Arts-Integrated Schools Continue to Lead Charter Organizing

Arts Academy in the Woods (2012) and Boggs School (2013 RC petition, withdrawn) join a pattern visible in Connecticut (cooperative/project-based), Oregon (rural experiential), and Pennsylvania (arts-integrated Westinghouse Arts) — schools whose educational missions create collective staff identities that translate directly into organizing drives. The 20-1 AAW vote mirrors the unanimity seen at other mission-driven first movers. AAW's employment page continues to highlight union membership as an institutional value, suggesting that organized status has become constitutive of school identity.

Alter-Ego Employer Tactic: Management Company Restructuring as Union-Avoidance Strategy

UYA's New Urban Learning / InspirED case is the most documented example in the NAPCS dataset of a charter employer attempting to escape a union certification by restructuring the management company. The NLRB's alter-ego doctrine — which binds a successor employer when management, ownership, and operations are substantially continuous — defeated this strategy, resulting in a federal complaint. This pattern has been documented in other states (IL, NY) where management company changes coincide with organizing drives. Charter leaders should note that management company restructuring does not eliminate certified union obligations when the NLRB finds alter-ego or successor status.

MEA vs. AFT Target Population Divide: Different Unions for Different School Types

In Michigan, MEA/NEA and AFT-Michigan (Michigan ACTS) have organically divided their target populations. MEA has focused on MERC-jurisdiction schools (community-oriented, ISD/locally-authorized, suburban and small-city charters), using card-check where available. Michigan ACTS has focused on NLRB-jurisdiction schools in Detroit's urban charter market. This division may reflect strategic calculation by each union about where their organizing infrastructure is most effective, or it may reflect natural geographic and political alignment. Either way, the result is that NAPCS schools (which skew urban/Detroit) are AFT territory, while the broader MI charter universe (which includes suburban and rural schools) is MEA territory.

Right-to-Work Repeal: New Variable in Michigan Charter Organizing Calculus

Michigan's repeal of right-to-work for private-sector employees (effective February 2024) adds a new organizing incentive absent from most other NAPCS states. In right-to-work states (AZ, FL), even certified unions cannot require dues payment as a condition of employment, which reduces union stability and bargaining leverage. Michigan's repeal means that new CBAs at NLRB-jurisdiction charter schools can now include union security clauses — increasing both the financial sustainability of charter locals and the union's bargaining power. This

change post-dates the AAW (2012) and UYA (2015) organizing drives but will benefit any new organizing campaigns going forward.

CA Case Type as Certification Proof — Cesar Chavez Academy Named Exemplar (Session C)

Section 8(a)(5) ULP charges (CA cases) filed by a union against an employer can ONLY be filed when the union holds a valid NLRB certification. When NLRB ADS returns 0 RC results for a school but shows CA charges filed by a union against that employer, the CA charges constitute proof of certification. Cesar Chavez Academy Detroit (all 4 campuses) is the named exemplar: prior This research concluded "no certification" based on 0 NLRB ADS RC results. However, 10 Michigan ACTS CA charges against the Leona Group / CCA (2013-2019) were visible in the ADS and prove Michigan ACTS held a valid certification throughout that period. A 2016 AFT Michigan press release confirming a second 5-year contract ratified 91-3 provides independent corroboration. Cross-state application: in any NAPCS state, if the ADS shows a union filing CA charges against a charter school employer, the school should be treated as CONFIRMED unless a subsequent RD (decertification) case appears. This rule applies retroactively to all prior NLRB-jurisdiction states.

Michigan Charter School Transparency Page as Secondary Detection Source

Michigan law requires all charter schools (public school academies) to post annual transparency reports on their websites, including health benefit terms for staff. When the transparency report references "the current bargaining agreement" as the governing instrument for teacher benefits, this is secondary-source confirmation of an active CBA. Grand Rapids Child Discovery Center (C2600004) confirmed this: the 2025-26 transparency page explicitly states "Health benefits for teaching staff are directed by the current bargaining agreement." This detection method is particularly useful for MERC-jurisdiction schools where the MERC portal may not contain digitized records for older certifications. Refresh protocol: check Michigan charter school transparency reporting pages at childdiscoverycenter.org/transparency-reporting style URLs annually. Union name and case details still require MERC FOIA.

Section 5: Media Coverage & Public Stakeholder Positions

Press Coverage

Publication	Date	Headline / Title	Notes / Summary
HuffPost / Michigan media	~January 2012	Arts Academy in the Woods charter school teachers vote to unionize (first charter school in MI to unionize)	Teachers at AAW voted 20-1 to join Michigan Alliance of Charter Teachers and Staff (Michigan ACTS), AFT Local 6482. Brandon Moss (English teacher) was organizing spokesperson. Board president stated the board did not dispute right to organize.
AFT Michigan / Detroit Metro Times	May 7, 2015	University Yes Academy teachers vote to form union	Teachers at UYA voted 27-18 to form a union with Michigan ACTS (AFT Local 6482). Vote certified May 14, 2015 (NLRB case 07-RC-148928). Employer (New Urban Learning) simultaneously announced it would leave as management company, creating successor-employer complications.
AFT Michigan / Detroit Metro Times	March 29, 2016	NLRB steps in to hold Detroit charter school accountable — alter-ego employer complaint	NLRB filed complaint alleging New Urban Learning CEO Lesley Redwine created InspirED as alter-ego corporation to evade bargaining with Michigan ACTS at UYA. Hearing scheduled June 6, 2016. UYA teachers: "We were told our vote didn't count."
Michigan Education Report / Mackinac Center	May 2000	State's largest charter school organized by labor union (MEA, 2000)	Mid-Michigan Public School Academy (now MMLA) became the largest unionized charter school in the nation

			when 38 teachers voted to join MEA in January 2000. MERC-jurisdiction. NAPCS baseline reflects this election. Current union status unclear — no CBA on Mackinac database; SABIS management.
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Section 6: Contract & CBA Access Registry

MERC / NLRB Region 7 public contracts portal. Direct PDF links may return 403 — OPRA or equivalent records request required for full text.

School / Network	Union	CBA Status & Term	Contract Access
Arts Academy in the Woods (C2601002)	Arts Academy in the Woods Federation of Teachers (Michigan ACTS / AFT Local 6482)	Active — successive CBAs since ~2012-13 Unknown. Gap: CBA period not publicly posted. Obtainable via AFT Michigan or school HR directly (no FOIA required).	artsacad.net/employment/ — confirms active union. Direct request to school or AFT Michigan for CBA text — no FOIA required.
University Yes Academy (C2610008)	Michigan Alliance of Charter Teachers and Staff (Michigan ACTS / AFT Local 6482)	UNKNOWN — certified May 14, 2015 (07-RC-148928); post-management-change status unconfirmed Unknown — NLRB/MERC records request required	NLRB ADS case 07-RC-148928 public page confirmed. Post-2016: search NLRB ADS for "University Yes Academy" / "New Paradigm for Education" — free public search, no FOIA needed.
Cesar Chavez Academy network — all 4 NAPCS campuses (C2601012, C2609001, C2699073, C2699074)	Michigan Alliance of Charter Teachers & Staff (Michigan ACTS) / AFT Michigan	Second 5-year contract ratified 91-3 (~2016 per AFT Michigan press release). Post-Leona Group (~2019) successor contract status unknown. Second contract: ~2016-2021. Successor contract unknown — direct contact with Michigan ACTS (AFT Michigan, Detroit) or NLRB R7 FOIA required.	AFT Michigan (aftmichigan.org) — Michigan ACTS division. Direct contact for current CBA status. NLRB ADS search for "Cesar Chavez Academy" post-2019 for any new case filings.
Grand Rapids Child Discovery Center (C2600004)	Unknown — MERC FOIA required (merc@michigan.gov)	ACTIVE — confirmed via school transparency page (2025-26): "Health benefits for teaching staff are directed by the current bargaining agreement." Unknown — MERC FOIA required	childdiscoverycenter.org/transparency-reporting (confirms active CBA). Union identity: email merc@michigan.gov or contact GRPS HR.

Section 7: Decisions, Monitoring & Notable Findings

Part A: Decisions Required

The following items require sponsor action before research or workbook entry can proceed.

Priority	School / Scope	Item	Who
HIGH	C2696006 — Mid-Michigan Leadership Academy	Michigan FOIA Act request to MERC — MEA certified Jan 2000 (38-21); failed decert (30-16); no current CBA found in Mackinac database; SABIS now manages. MERC 2000-era records not in public digital portal — formal records request required (email merc@michigan.gov). If MEA still active: recode to CONFIRMED.	Research Coordinator — Michigan FOIA Act request to MERC (email merc@michigan.gov)
HIGH	C2610008 — University Yes Academy	Search NLRB ADS (nlr.gov/search/case) for employer names "University Yes Academy" and "New Paradigm for Education" — filter post-2016, look for CA (ULP) or RC (election) cases. This is a free public search; no FOIA required. If no cases found: NPFE likely continued without Michigan ACTS — recode UYA to UNVERIFIED. If CA cases found: employer likely refused to bargain (still CONFIRMED); if RD (decert) case found: DECERTIFIED.	Research Coordinator — NLRB ADS public search (nlr.gov/search/case), no FOIA needed
HIGH	C2601002 — Arts Academy in the Woods	Search NLRB ADS (nlr.gov/search/case) for employer "Arts Academy in the Woods" Region 7, cases filed 2011-2012. Case page shows cert date, vote tally, and unit description publicly — no FOIA required. CBA terms: direct request to school or AFT Michigan.	Research Coordinator — NLRB ADS public search (nlr.gov/search/case), no FOIA needed

Part B: Notable Findings

Research findings of strategic significance. No immediate action required — for awareness and discussion.

No notable findings flagged for this state.

Part C: Active Monitoring

Items being tracked. Status may change between report cycles. Research Coordinator manages ongoing surveillance.

Priority	School / Scope	Item	Who
MEDIUM	MGLVA — Stride K12 / Michigan Great Lakes Virtual Academy (non-NAPCS)	Active ULP 07-CA-356535 (MEA, filed Dec 2024, open). Monitor NLRB ADS for any RC petition at MGLVA. If RC filed: check if MGLVA in NAPCS dataset.	Research Coordinator — NLRB ADS monitoring
MEDIUM	C2601012 / C2609001 / C2699073 / C2699074 — Cesar Chavez Academy network	CORRECTED Session C (May 24, 2026): CCA network is CONFIRMED — Michigan ACTS certified Feb 7, 2013 (2:1 margin); second 5-year contract ratified 91-3 (~2016). Post-Leona Group (~2019) status requires verification. Monitor for: (1) NLRB R7 FOIA for RC case number and exact cert date; (2) Whether Michigan ACTS remains recognized under independently operated CCA nonprofit;	Research Coordinator — NLRB R7 FOIA + ADS monitoring

		(3) Any new NLRB R7 cases under "Cesar Chavez Academy" post-2019.	
MEDIUM	James and Grace Lee Boggs School	NLRB RC petition 07-RC-115187 (October 2013) filed by Michigan ACTS — withdrawn 16 days later. Progressive, mission-intensive school in Detroit market where AFT-Michigan has active infrastructure. Prior organizing interest documented. Monitor NLRB ADS for new RC or CA cases.	Research Coordinator
HIGH	University Yes Academy	Certified May 14, 2015. Post-management-change CBA status unknown. If NPFE does not recognize Michigan ACTS as successor, school may face renewed organizing or ULP action. NPFE manages multiple Detroit charter schools — labor relations posture across network is relevant.	Research Coordinator
HIGH	Mid-Michigan Leadership Academy	MEA was certified January 2000 (38-21 vote). Failed decertification attempt (30-16). No current CBA on Mackinac database. SABIS now manages. Either MEA is still the certified representative (in which case school is CONFIRMED) or MEA was decertified (in which case MERC records would show decertification). Michigan FOIA Act request to MERC is required — MERC 2000-era certifications not in public digital portal.	Research Coordinator
HIGH	Cesar Chavez Academy network	CONFIRMED Session C May 24, 2026 — Michigan ACTS certified Feb 7, 2013 (2:1 margin); second 5-year contract ratified 91-3 (~2016). Leona Group departed ~2019. Monitor: (1) NLRB R7 FOIA for RC case number; (2) Post-2019 NLRB ADS for any new R7 cases; (3) Whether Michigan ACTS/AFT Michigan still recognized under successor CCA nonprofit. Second contract expired ~2021 — successor unknown.	Research Coordinator
MEDIUM	Grand Rapids Child Discovery Center	CONFIRMED Session C May 24, 2026 — active CBA per 2025-26 transparency page. MERC jurisdiction. Union name/case# unknown — MERC FOIA pending. Monitor: (1) Annual transparency page check; (2) MERC FOIA response for case details.	Research Coordinator